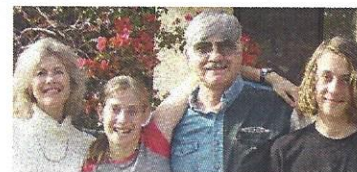


He is Risen, He is Risen Indeed!

Saracoff Sentinel/Team Tijuana

Spring 2006



Points for Prayer

- May Easter's message transform us!
- Integrity/protection for marriages and families of ministry leaders. May God's name be exalted, not sullied.
- La Roca's vision is to start a Christian school and provide quality education for the teens living at La Roca. Pray it happens!
- A recent land dispute near Esperanza's women's center left families evicted in the rain. Pray for just negotiations and secure future for the women's rehab.
- Praise God for His provision of industrial stove and donors willing to help with electrical transformer and bills at Home for the Elderly. Funerals still are a major expense for Pastor Chuy.
- Pray for Napoleon as he will be the lead person in the micro-finance project. Pray for a godly professional to mentor the groups and that Christians participate and give personal witness to God's life-changing power.
- Guidance as we make summer plans with teams coming and family vacation.
- Pray for Kathy's dad undergoing knee replacement on April 11th that God is glorified and healing would be complete.

Latin America Mission

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Saracoff Ministry

www.teamtijuana.org

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Let us hear from you!

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MN Snow Days

by Kathy

This spring our family has been on the move. Sadly, since his dad's death in November, Greg has had to fly to IND a few times to help deal with the estate.

A happier trip was one in late March made to Minnesota to visit a supporting church and attend a missions conference up by Lake Superior. We had the joy of inviting Javier and Lidia Marquez from Esperanza Rehab to join us and the weather was winter wonderland at its best.



We got to see my brothers' families and many friends. One highlight was seeing Metro Hope, a men's recovery program where my brother works. Also SOS (Solar Oven Society) gave an oven to Javier to try out in sun-rich, fuel-costly TJ.

Micro Finance Now

by Greg

In March Kathy, Anna, and I took a trip to Mexico City. It was a good time of fellowship with other missionaries in Mexico with the LAM. It also was a good chance for Kathy and me to see micro finance in action. FIPS (*Fundación Productiva Sustentable*) who will be our partner in Tijuana to do micro finance is presently working with over 5,000 indigenous Mexican ladies in Guajuato and Oaxaca.

We met 9 ladies who had bought an oven and were baking "pan dulce." Another group had financed a greenhouse to grow the small tomatoes that Mexicans love in their salsa. Other ventures were tortilla factory/taco kitchen.

We face 3 challenges now as we come back. The first is to adapt the model from

indigenous groups in rural areas to Tijuana and the urban poor.

The second challenge is to make sure that the Christian witness will be a primary objective of the program. Unfortunately many Christian business and educational institutions in the past have become purely secular. Our long-term goal is to see fulfilled people open to the gospel who can support their pastors.

The third challenge is to start 250 poor people in 20 community bank groups in the next months and find funds to lend. (see prayer points at left).



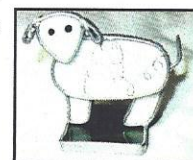
A new member for the community bank.

Easter: Reflecting on the Cross

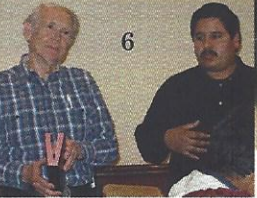
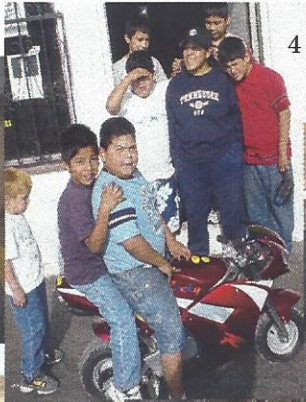
Some of the men at the Rehab make stained glass lambs and crosses. The lamb in particular makes me think of Jesus' sacrifice for our salvation and how as our Risen Lord He is also the Good Shepherd leading us.

Oswald Chambers in My Utmost for His Highest says "The centre of salvation is the Cross

of Jesus, and the reason it is so easy to obtain salvation is because it cost God so much. The Cross is the point where God and sinful man merge with a crash and the way to life is opened—but the crash is on the heart of God." (April 6).



Recent Tijuana Photo Ops



1. Chela's tutoring club meets 3-4 days a week.
2. One of Enoch's soccer teams, a great outreach to kids.
3. Kathy and her mom receiving gifts from Esperanza leaders, Tina and Lidia.
4. Chela also works with kids at Esperanza's downtown Rescue Mission.
5. Yesenia's quinceñera (15th) marks an important rite of passage to adulthood.
6. Korean team helps install computer lab at Esperanza.
7. New mosaic floor in lab. Can you read its great message?
8. Frank Dennis (my dad) shares with Team TJ as Napoleon translates.
9. Pickup load of dirty blankets from Elderly Home. My friend Cheryl came on her birthday to wash it.
10. Moms in Touch retreat with Fern Nichols and Hispanic moms.
11. Two ladies in rehab at Esperanza display a quilting project.
12. Pastor Javier Marquez and his family, part of our Team Tijuana.

FAMILY UPDATE

You might be wondering what's new in the Saracoff family. Ian and Anna are both attending Hilltop High, as 11th and 9th graders, respectively. Pray for Ian as next month he gets to take 3 big AP tests (that's Advanced Placement), plus the SAT is looming on the horizon.

Anna's interests are taking some unusual twists—she's in the Japanese folk dance club at school and does carpentry at home with Dad. Room décor Asian.